

FELIX BENTIL

Email: felixbentil@gmail.com| Mobile: +1(605) 480-3479

LinkedIn: <https://www.linkedin.com/in/felix-bentil-0808789a>

OBJECTIVE

Prospective Ph.D student advanced research training in cybersecurity education and research. Research interests include critical Infrastructure security, vulnerability discovery, system and application security with a focus on building secure, trustworthy, and human-centered computing systems. Committed to contributing rigorous, publishable research and advancing computer science education.

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Critical infrastructure security, vulnerability discovery, cybersecurity implications of quantum computing, system and application security

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- Security & Systems: Network and web security, vulnerability assessment, penetration testing, threat modeling, CPS/ICS security, network traffic analysis
- Programming & Data: Python, Bash, SQL; machine learning for security (scikit-learn, TensorFlow, PyTorch); data analysis and model evaluation
- Platforms & Infrastructure: Linux (Kali, Ubuntu), Windows Server, Active Directory, Azure; virtualization (VMware, VirtualBox)
- Tools & Monitoring: Burp Suite, Nmap, Metasploit, Wireshark, Nessus; Splunk, ELK Stack, Wazuh
- Governance & Risk: ISO/IEC 27001, ISO 27701, PCI DSS, SWIFT CSP, NIST CSF; risk assessment, policy development
- Research & Teaching: Experimental design, academic writing, reproducible research practices, graduate level teaching support

EDUCATION

Dakota State University, USA MS Cyber Defense 2026 – 2027

Lovely Professional University, India M.Sc. Computer Science 2019 – 2021

University of Education, Winneba, Ghana B.Sc. IT Education 2010 – 2014

GRE: 323 (Quant: 163, Verbal: 160, AWA: 3.5)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cybersecurity Consultant & Training Lead KPMG Ghana Jan 2022 - Jul 2026

- Led network, mobile, web, and API vulnerability assessment and penetration testing engagements for clients in diverse industries.
- Conduct cybersecurity audits and assessments using ISO 27001, PCI-DSS, and NIST CSF frameworks.
- Designed and implemented remediation strategies aligned with business risk and compliance priorities.

- Served as Training Lead for the IT Advisory Unit, driving technical upskilling, organizing workshops, and mentoring junior consultants.
- Active member of the Thought Leadership Team, contributing to research-based insights, articles, and firmwide strategy discussions on emerging cyber threats.

Security Analyst (Intern) Indian Cyber Security Solutions

Jun 2020 - Feb 2021

- Conducted hands-on penetration tests on web and IoT and industrial control systems, identifying and documenting exploitable flaws in insecure robotic communication protocols.
- Helped enhance the security of IoT platforms by recommending patches and secure configurations.

Web Application Pentester (Freelance)

Bugcrowd

Mar 2020 - Dec 2020

- Executed targeted penetration tests on clients' web apps and APIs, identifying business logic flaws, misconfigurations, and access control issues.
- Submitted 20+ valid vulnerability reports with detailed remediation guidance, earning client acknowledgments and bug bounty rewards.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Graduate Teaching Assistant Department of Computer Applications, LPU

Jan 2020 - Feb 2021

- Assisted in delivering lectures and lab sessions.
- Conducted review sessions and provided clarification on students' questions.
- Graded assignments, and exams, and provided constructive feedback to improve student performance.
- Assisted in developing course materials, including assignments and lab exercises.

ICT Teacher Lead for Ghana Schools, Tamale, Ghana

Jun 2017 - Jul 2019

- Designed and delivered engaging ICT lessons aligned with the Ghana Education Service curriculum.
- Implemented various teaching strategies to accommodate diverse learning styles.
- Fostered a collaborative and inclusive classroom environment that encouraged student participation and critical thinking.
- Provided individualized support and tutoring to students who needed extra assistance.

ICT Teacher, Imam Mahadi Educational Complex, Ghana

Sep 2015 - Jul 2016

- Evaluated and supervised student activities and performance levels to provide reports on academic progress.
- Implemented creative ways to foster curiosity for complex concepts through hands-on learning and planned activities.
- Collaborated with parents of slow-learning students to increase comprehensive and long-term success.

ICT Teacher (Intern) Ajumako Senior High School, Ghana

Sep 2013 - Dec 2013

- Developed ICT lesson plans and modified them as needed to meet time constraints and the specific learning interest of the class.
- Conducted engaging in-class discussions to facilitate learning and encourage participation.

RESEARCH & PROJECTS

IoT Firmware Security Analysis - Independent Research

- Analyzed IoT device firmware using Binwalk and Firmwalker to uncover secrets, hardcoded credentials, and insecure configurations.
- Experimented with QEMU-based emulation of IoT firmware images for dynamic testing.
- Conducted reconnaissance on internet-exposed IoT devices using Shodan/Censys, mapping common weaknesses.
- Investigated robot communication vulnerabilities using captured packets and insecure UDP/TCP messaging.

Malware Analysis & Reverse Engineering – Independent Research

- Performed static and dynamic analysis on Windows and Android malware samples using Ghidra, x64dbg, and Cuckoo Sandbox.
- Conducted memory forensics with Volatility, extracting indicators of compromise (IOCs) and analyzing behavioral artifacts.
- Authored YARA rules to detect malicious patterns and developed basic sandbox-based behavioral profiles.
- Documented findings in research logs aligning with academic reporting standards.

Vulnerability Research & Bug Bounty Findings (2019 - Present)

- Reported 20+ valid vulnerabilities, including critical issues such as IDOR, authentication bypass, rate limit bypass, and insecure API exposure.
- One major IDOR finding led to a published vulnerability disclosure article on insecure academic platform data exposure.
- Conducted offensive security testing on mobile and web applications using OWASP methodologies.

Credit Card Fraud Detection Using Machine Learning

- Developed and trained ML models to detect anomalous transaction behavior.
- Integrated location and behavioral patterns to trigger real-time alerts.

Cybersecurity Thought Leadership - KPMG Ghana

- As a core member of the IT Advisory Thought Leadership Team, contributed to the design, authorship, and peer-review of internal and external research publications, strategic briefs, and emerging threat landscape analyses.
- Topics covered include software supply chain risks, cloud security trends, and identity management in enterprise environments.

Papers, Articles, & Publications

- Exposing Insecure Direct Object Reference (IDOR) Vulnerabilities in Academic Publication Platforms: A Case Study), Published in International Journal of Engineering Research and Technology (IJERT), Volume 13, Issue 08 (August 2024), <https://www.ijert.org/exposing-insecure-direct-object-reference-idor-vulnerabilities-in-academic-publication-platforms-a-case-study>

- Cloud Cryptography – A Security Aspect, Published in International Journal of Engineering Research and Technology (IJERT), Volume 10, Issue 05 (May 2021).
<https://www.ijert.org/cloud-cryptography-a-security-aspect>
- A Survey of Open-Source Cloud Computing, Published in International Journal of Emerging Technologies and Innovative Research (IJETIR), ISSN:2349-5162, Vol. 8, Issue 5 page no.e85-e91, May 2021. <https://www.jetir.org/view?paper=JETIR2105544>
- Missing SPF Records Leading to Email Forgery, Published on Medium,
<https://medium.com/@kwesithehacker/missing-spf-records-leading-to-email-forgery-1e305102eaff>
- Leaving the Vault Open: The Danger of Default Credentials, Published on LinkedIn,
<https://www.linkedin.com/pulse/leaving-vault-open-danger-default-credentials-felix-bentil-hsu3e?trackingId=8427odJ2tusQf8Lb1Hg9A%3D%3D>

CONFERENCES, WORKSHOPS, AND PRESENTATIONS

- Speaker (API Security Testing), KPMG Ghana Knowledge Sharing Session (2023)
- Speaker, KPMG Global Cyber Day Oct 2022/2023
- Speaker (The Art of Social Engineering), EduSpots Monthly Series (2021)
- Speaker (Cyber Security and Maintaining Online Safety), REALITY Revolve Alumni Ghana Leadership Series (2021)
- Speaker (Ethical Hacking Journey and Dark Web), Vayhive Community – India, (2021)
- Participant, Global Emerging Innovation Summit, India (2021)
- IBM Conference on Data Science and Machine Learning, India

LEADERSHIP & VOLUNTEER EXPERIENCE

Founder & Lead Trainer – CyberHunt (Non-Profit Initiative) Accra, Ghana 2023 - Present

- Founded CyberHunt to provide free cybersecurity education and career mentorship.
- Trained over 70 individuals in ethical hacking, penetration testing, and cybersecurity fundamentals.
- Facilitated internship and job placements by connecting trainees with local startups and tech companies.

CyberDay Champion – KPMG Ghana Accra, Ghana 2023 - 2026

- Led the KPMG Global CyberDay initiative in Ghana, organizing outreach programs to educate students.
- Delivered engaging sessions on cyber hygiene and digital safety in primary and secondary schools.
- Honored with the KPMG Community Impact Award in both 2023 and 2024 for outstanding contribution.

Training Lead – Cybersecurity Unit KPMG, Ghana 2023 - 2026

- Led the design and delivery of technical training programs across the Cybersecurity unit, ensuring consultants stay up-to-date with the latest threat trends, tools, and frameworks.
- Developed structured learning tracks covering VAPT, ISO 27001, PCI DSS, SWIFT CSP, and cybersecurity governance for new joiners and mid-level professionals.
- Mentored junior team members and interns, fostering a culture of continuous learning, technical excellence, and hands-on security consulting.

- Coordinated internal knowledge-sharing sessions and labs to improve red teaming, secure configuration reviews, and risk analysis capabilities across the team.

Campus Director – Hult Prize Foundation, Lovely Professional University, India

2020 - 2021

- Appointed as Campus Director to lead the LPU chapter of the world's largest student social innovation competition, backed by the UN and former President Bill Clinton.
- Mobilized 300+ students to participate in entrepreneurship and innovation workshops focused on impact-driven business solutions.
- Organized and hosted the On-Campus Finals, attracting judges and mentors from the startup ecosystem and faculty leadership.
- Provided coaching and mentorship to finalist teams, one of which advanced to regional summits.
- Built partnerships with student bodies and external organizations to promote social entrepreneurship and youth leadership.

Coding Volunteer GhScientific, Ghana

2018 – 2019

- Mentored high school students in coding and problem-solving through interactive sessions.
- Promoted digital literacy in underserved communities by delivering tech workshops

PROFESSIONAL CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Red Team Analyst (CRTA)
- eLearnSecurity Junior Penetration Tester (eJPT)
- Certified Ethical Hacker (CEH) – EC-Council
- Certified in Cybersecurity (CC) – (ISC)2
- ISO 27001 Lead Implementer – PECB
- PECB Certified Trainer
- Microsoft Security, Compliance and Identify (SC-900)
- Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900)
- Network Security Associate – Fortinet
- Certified AppSec Practitioner – SecOps
- Certified API Security Architect – API Academy
- Digital Forensics Essentials – EC-Council
- KPMG Accredited Penetration Tester

AFFILIATIONS

- KPMG Global Pentesters
- International Information Systems Security Certification Consortium (ISC2)
- Blacks in Cybersecurity

LANGUAGES

- English - Fluent
- French - Intermediate Proficiency
- German - Basic Proficiency